launch an investigation and say he had broken the Espionage Act of 1917.

An Uneasy Future

As his identity was about to be made public, Snowden worried about his safety. The United States could try to legally extradite him from China. CIA operatives might grab him and throw him on a plane bound for the United States. Or the Chinese government might become involved; seeing him as a valuable source of information, they might capture and question him. "All of my options are bad," Snowden told Greenwald. Snowden at least hoped the publicity of the leaks would give him some safety by making it "harder for them to get dirty."[5]

In the end, Snowden wanted to seek asylum in a country that had no extradition treaty with the United States and that promoted Internet freedom, such as

ESPIONAGE ACT

The Espionage Act passed in 1917 to give then-President Woodrow Wilson a way to prosecute dissidents during World War I. It allows for prison sentences and even the death penalty for publishing or speaking about information that might be harmful to the United States or interfere with military operations when the country is at war. Sometimes called the Sedition Act of 1918, it was made less severe under a new Espionage Act passed by Congress during World War II, but many people concerned about civil liberties still believe the act goes too far in restricting free speech.

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